SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

29 October 2024 · Shift 1

75 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 15 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 13 questions

Q.1

A container has 72 litre of pure milk. One–third of the milk is replaced by water in the container. Again, one–third of the mixture is extracted and an equal amount of water is added. What is the ratio of milk to water in the new mixture?

(A) 2 : 3
(B) 1 : 2
(C) 3 : 4
(D) 4 : 5

Q.3

The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 70 kg and 36 kg is:

(A) 52.2
(B) 50.2
(C) 49.2
(D) 51.2

Q.4

The sum of two natural numbers is 80 and their HCF is 10. How many such pairs of numbers are possible?

(A) 2
(B) 3
(C) 8
(D) 7

Q.5

Find the average of all the numbers between 21 and 70 which are divisible by 3 and leave the remainder 2.

(A) 65.5
(B) 45.5
(C) 55.6
(D) 55.4

Q.6

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 6% per year rate of interest for 2 years.

(A) 380
(B) 420
(C) 460
(D) 360

Q.7

Ankur sells a box to Sunita earning a profit of 20%. Sunita sold it to Mohit with a 9% profit. Mohit sold it to Anjali for ₹24,525 thereby gaining 25%. At what price (in ₹) did Ankur buy the box?

(A) 20000
(B) 15000
(C) 12000
(D) 17000

Q.11

The price of a pencil is increased by ₹2 this year and ₹2 in the previous year. The price of a pencil is now 30% more than the price in the previous to the previous year. How much is the price of the pencil now in ₹?

(A) 17.33
(B) 14.33
(C) 15.33
(D) 13.33

Q.12

The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 70 kg and 38 kg is:

(A) 52.6
(B) 51.6
(C) 49.6
(D) 50.6

Q.13

A metallic cone of radius 12 cm and height 36 cm is melted and made into spheres of radius 3 cm each. How many spheres are there?

(A) 74
(B) 48
(C) 58
(D) 34

Q.14

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2000 as a sum borrowed at 7% per year rate of interest for 5 years.

(A) 640
(B) 700
(C) 740
(D) 660

Q.15

Find the curved surface area and total surface area, respectively, of a cylinder of radius of base 28 m and height 40 m.

(A) 7000 m^2 and 11,968 m^2
(B) 7040 m^2 and 11,768 m^2
(C) 7040 m^2 and 11,008 m^2
(D) 7040 m^2 and 11,968 m^2

Q.16

The simple interest on a certain sum at the rate of 12.5% p.a. for 3 years and 6 months is ₹6,750 less than the principal. Find out the principal.

(A) ₹12,000
(B) ₹12,350
(C) ₹10,000
(D) ₹10,650

Q.20

P and Q walk along a circular track in opposite directions. P completes two rounds of the track in 1 minute and Q completes three rounds of the track in the same time. They start from the same point and walk for 2 minutes. How many times will they meet on the track between start time and end time?

(A) 11
(B) 8
(C) 10
(D) 9

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 14 questions

Q.1

OD 11 is related to KH 15 in a certain way. In the same way, ID 5 is related to EH 9. To which of the following is LK 3 related, following the same logic?

(A) HP 7
(B) HO –3
(C) HO 3
(D) HO 7

Q.2

Read the given statement(s) and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: Some gums are candies. No candy is a ball. Conclusions: (I) Atleast some candies are gums. (II) No ball is a gum.

(A) Only conclusion (I) follows.
(B) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows.
(C) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow.
(D) Only conclusion (II) follows.

Q.5

A, B, C, D, E, F, and G, are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Only 2 people sit between A and B when counted from the left of A. Both G and F are immediate neighbours of A. C sits immediate to the left of E. Only 2 people sit between D and G when counted from the right of D. How many people sit between E and F when counted from the left of F?

(A) 2
(B) 4
(C) 1
(D) 3

Q.6

OGMI is related to LDJF in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, SKQM is related to PHNJ. To which of the following is VNTP related, following the same logic?

(A) SKQM
(B) SKMQ
(C) KSMQ
(D) KSQM

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'GOLF' is coded as '1286' and 'WOLF' is coded as '6428'. What is the code for 'W' in that language?

(A) 6
(B) 2
(C) 4
(D) 8

Q.8

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 92 + 36 – 28 + (42 ÷ 3) – (22 × 4) = 10 (Note: Interchange should be done of entire number and not individual digits of a given number)

(A) 3 and 4
(B) 42 and 36
(C) 22 and 28
(D) 36 and 28

Q.9

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All pens are razors. All razors are creams. Conclusions: (I) All pens are creams. (II) All creams are razors.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(B) Both conclusion I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.10

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/ subtracting /multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 23, 230; 46, 460

(A) 52, 520
(B) 84, 410
(C) 35, 620
(D) 24, 120

Q.11

4 is related to 15 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 15 is related to 48. To which of the following is 7 related following the same logic?(NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbersinto its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /subtracting /multiplying etc. to 13can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1and 3 is not allowed)

(A) 23
(B) 28
(C) 24
(D) 21

Q.15

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? DHC, GKF, JNI, MQL, ?

(A) PTO
(B) QVQ
(C) QTO
(D) PUP

Q.17

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 39 ÷ 3 – 11 + 45 × 17 = 171

(A) – and +
(B) + and ×
(C) ÷ and ×
(D) – and ×

Q.18

In a certain code language, 'BEST' is coded as '9715' and 'CLUB' is coded as '8762'. What is the code for 'B' in the given code language?

(A) 7
(B) 6
(C) 9
(D) 2

Q.19

In a certain code language, ‘TIME’ is written as ‘3629’ and ‘BEND’ is written as ‘4582’. How is ‘E’ written in that code language?

(A) 4
(B) 9
(C) 2
(D) 5

Q.20

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 42, 48, 54, 60, 66, ?

(A) 71
(B) 73
(C) 70
(D) 72

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

The original non-metamorphic rock that undergoes profound physical or chemical changes leading to the formation of a metamorphic rock is known as:

(A) Laterite
(B) Bedrock
(C) Regolith
(D) Protolith

Q.2

According to the Census of India 2011, what was the total population of India?

(A) 1.41 billion
(B) 98.6 billion
(C) 1.21 billion
(D) 1.11 billion

Q.3

Which of the following is NOT a Fundamental Duty mentioned in the Indian constitution?

(A) To cherish and follow the noble ideals which inspired our national struggle for freedom

(B) To uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India

(C) To obey parents and discharge our family responsibilities

(D) To abide by the Constitution and respect its ideals and institutions, the National Flag, National Anthem

Q.4

Which of the following are the amounts of nutrients in a keto diet?

(A) High protein and fat, carbohydrates in a low amount

(B) Only taking high number of vitamins and minerals

(C) High carbohydrate, proper amount of protein and low fat

(D) High amount of fat, adequate protein and low carbohydrate

Q.5

Padma awardee Arjun Singh Dhurve is related to which of the following folk dances?

(A) Chhau

(B) Baiga

(C) Garba

(D) Raslila

Q.6

Magnolia and Laurel trees are found in which type of forest in India?

(A) Mangrove Forests

(B) Tropical Deciduous Forests

(C) Montane Forests

(D) Tropical Thorn Forests

Q.7

Duare Ration Scheme, which has been deemed legally void by the high court, was launched by which of the following states?

(A) Madhya Pradesh

(B) Punjab

(C) West Bengal

(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.8

In 1927, where was the conference against colonial oppression and imperialism, in which Jawaharlal Nehru participated on behalf of Indian National Congress, held?

(A) Antwerp

(B) Leuven

(C) Brussels

(D) Bruges

Q.9

Who became the first Indian woman to be inducted into the ICC Hall of Fame?

(A) Diana Edulji

(B) Jhulan Goswami

(C) Mithali Raj

(D) Purnima Rau

Q.10

In January 2023, who was sworn in as the Chief Minister of Bihar for the ninth time?

(A) Tejaswi Yadav

(B) Lalu Yadav

(C) Nitish Kumar

(D) Sushil Modi

Q.11

The ‘Rath Yatra’ festival of Puri is celebrated as the sacred journey of which of the following Hindu deities?

(A) Lord Rama

(B) Lord Shiva

(C) Lord Jagannath

(D) Lord Brahma

Q.12

Who among the following personalities from the Carnatic Music correctly represent the ‘Trinity of Carnatic Music'?

(A) Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar and Syama Sastri

(B) MS Subbalakshmi, DK Pattammal and ML Vasanthakumari

(C) Purandardas, Annamacharya and Tyagaraja

(D) Manambuchavadi Venkatasubbayyar, Tyagaraja and Muthuswami Dikshitar

Q.13

Who is the chairman of the State Planning Board?

(A) Governor

(B) Advocate General

(C) Speaker

(D) Chief Minister

Q.14

The Ashokan inscriptions of Afghanistan are written in Aramaic and _____ scripts.

(A) Greek

(B) Sharda

(C) Devanagari

(D) Ol Chiki

Q.15

Revenue account includes items related to the _____.

(A) previous financial year

(B) current financial year

(C) next financial year

(D) all of the given options

Q.16

Which of the following is NOT a cropping season in India?

(A) Rabi

(B) Kharif

(C) Zaid

(D) Fang

Q.17

Which book has been authored by Rabindra Bharali?

(A) The Music Room

(B) Music to my Ears

(C) Indie 101

(D) The Forgotten Forms of Hindustani Music

Q.19

How many gold medals did Maharashtra win to top the medal tally at the 37th National Games event held in Goa?

(A) 80

(B) 79

(C) 72

(D) 69

Q.20

The element with atomic number 59 lies in which block of the Periodic Table?

(A) The f-block

(B) The d-block

(C) The p-block

(D) The s-block

Q.21

Which bonding material was mainly used to join the stones or bricks of 'The Great Bath' of the Harappan Civilisation?

(A) Gauged Mortar

(B) Mud Mortar

(C) Lime Mortar

(D) Gypsum Mortar

Q.22
Andal was one of the most famous women _____ saints.

(A) Nayanar
(B) Alvar
(C) Sufi
(D) Tantric

Q.23
Which of the following awards is NOT conferred for excellence in dance?

(A) Kalidas Samman Award
(B) Lalit Kala Akademi Award
(C) Sangeet Natak Akademi Award
(D) Padma Shree Award

Q.24
As per Census of India 2011, which of the following states has the highest child sex ratio (in the age group of 0-6 years)?

(A) Kerala
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Mizoram
(D) Chhattisgarh

Q.25
Which reform was initiated by Lord Ripon for the welfare of labourers?

(A) The Vernacular Press Act
(B) The Educational Reforms
(C) The Factory Act
(D) The Financial Decentralisation

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. She showed this plant and talked about "it's medicinal properties".

(A) it's medical properties
(B) their medical properties
(C) it's medical proprieties
(D) its medicinal properties

Q.2
Select the option that expresses the given sentence in simple future tense form. I loved.

(A) I shall be loving.
(B) I love.
(C) I will love.
(D) I had loved.

Q.3
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. "It's really _____ to incorporate changes at the last minute," she said.

(A) difficulty
(B) difficulties
(C) difficult
(D) most difficult

Q.4
Select the most appropriate adjective to fill in the blank. The judge declared that the red car went _____ than the blue car.

(A) farther
(B) far
(C) more far
(D) farthest

Q.5
Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Embarrassment
(B) Ocassion
(C) Recieve
(D) Acommodate

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word 'yelling' in the given sentence. The shouting and exclaiming gestures of Smita led to the whispering regarding her behaviour, and everyone in the party started monitoring her.

(A) exclaiming
(B) monitoring
(C) whispering
(D) shouting

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. An axe to grind

(A) To have a selfish reason that influences the actions
(B) To make a supreme effort
(C) To tackle a problem in a bold and direct fashion
(D) Bitterly hostile

Q.8

The following sentence has been divided into four segments. One of them contains an error. Select the segment that contains the error from the given options. She has been speaking / to him on / the subject / many times.

(A) many times
(B) to him on
(C) She has been speaking
(D) the subject

Q.9

The given sentence is divided into three segments. Select the option that has the segment with a grammatical error. If there is no error, select ‘No error’. She learnt / how to play a piano / when she was in Class 6th.

(A) No error
(B) when she was in Class 6th.
(C) how to play a piano
(D) She learnt

Q.10

Select the option that rectifies the spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. She always wears a “bizzare” combination of clothes.

(A) Bizare
(B) Bizaar
(C) Bizzar
(D) Bizarre

Q.11

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Despite the setbacks, the team decided to persevere and keep working on the project, believing it could be a _____ for their company.

(A) needle in a haystack
(B) beat around the bush
(C) wild goose chase
(D) game-changer

Q.12

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The act of transferring one's authority to another

(A) Mediary
(B) Delegation
(C) Agency
(D) Assignee

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. It is worth noting that the “possible from him” being voted as the class monitor is next to zero.

(A) possible of him
(B) possibility at him
(C) possibility of him
(D) possibly of him

Q.14

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Necessary
(B) Cuorse
(C) Consider
(D) Personal

Q.15

In the following sentence the underlined part contains as error. Alternatives to the underlined part are given as options. Select the correct alternative. The speech you made today was “sillier” and irrelevant.

(A) most silly
(B) silly
(C) silliest
(D) more silly

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM for the given word. Merciful

(A) Magical
(B) Cunning
(C) Mild
(D) Cruel

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word 'isolated' from the given sentence. A Greek mythological story says that Echo was the most beautiful nymph who lived in the lovely and lonely mountains of Greece and is believed to be garrulous too.

(A) Lonely
(B) Lovely
(C) Garrulous
(D) Beautiful

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Evasive

(A) Chaotic
(B) Obscure
(C) Elusive
(D) Truthful

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Diligent

(A) Lazy
(B) Industrious
(C) Positive
(D) Noisy

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a small village, lived a milkmaid _____1_____ sold the milk that she ____2_____ from her cows. She _____3_____ carry the milk in a big mud pitcher. One day, as she was walking _____4_____ the big pitcher full of milk on her head, she started to imagine all the things she wished to do with the money she would _____5_____ from selling the milk.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) which
(B) that
(C) whose
(D) who

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a small village, lived a milkmaid _____1_____ sold the milk that she ____2_____ from her cows. She _____3_____ carry the milk in a big mud pitcher. One day, as she was walking _____4_____ the big pitcher full of milk on her head, she started to imagine all the things she wished to do with the money she would _____5_____ from selling the milk.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) got
(B) bought
(C) brought
(D) drank

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a small village, lived a milkmaid _____1_____ sold the milk that she ____2_____ from her cows. She _____3_____ carry the milk in a big mud pitcher. One day, as she was walking _____4_____ the big pitcher full of milk on her head, she started to imagine all the things she wished to do with the money she would _____5_____ from selling the milk.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) will
(B) can
(C) should
(D) would

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a small village, lived a milkmaid _____1_____ sold the milk that she ____2_____ from her cows. She _____3_____ carry the milk in a big mud pitcher. One day, as she was walking _____4_____ the big pitcher full of milk on her head, she started to imagine all the things she wished to do with the money she would _____5_____ from selling the milk.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) in
(B) on
(C) with
(D) by

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. In a small village, lived a milkmaid _____1_____ sold the milk that she ____2_____ from her cows. She _____3_____ carry the milk in a big mud pitcher. One day, as she was walking _____4_____ the big pitcher full of milk on her head, she started to imagine all the things she wished to do with the money she would _____5_____ from selling the milk.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) catch
(B) earn
(C) throw
(D) dig

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**
Q.20 **(D)**					

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (D) 4 : 5

Each replacement leaves 2/3 of the milk: 72 × 2/3 × 2/3 = 32 litres of milk and 40 litres of water. 32 : 40 = 4 : 5.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 50.2

(40 + 49 + 56 + 70 + 36)/5 = 251/5 = 50.2 kg.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 2

Write the numbers as 10a and 10b with a and b coprime: a + b = 8 gives (1, 7) and (3, 5), while (2, 6) and (4, 4) share a factor. So there are 2 pairs: 10 and 70, 30 and 50.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 45.5

The numbers that leave remainder 2 on division by 3 are 23, 26, …, 68. They are evenly spaced, so their average is (23 + 68)/2 = 45.5.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 420

SI = 3,500 × 6 × 2/100 = ₹420.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 15000

Ankur's cost × 1.2 × 1.09 × 1.25 = ₹24,525. 1.2 × 1.09 × 1.25 = 1.635, so the cost is 24,525 ÷ 1.635 = ₹15,000.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 17.33

With P the price two years ago, the price now is P + 4 = 1.3P, so 0.3P = 4 and P = ₹13.33. The price now is 13.33 + 4 = ₹17.33.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 50.6

(40 + 49 + 56 + 70 + 38)/5 = 253/5 = 50.6 kg.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 48

The cone holds (1/3)π × 12^2 × 36 = 1,728π cm^3 and each sphere (4/3)π × 3^3 = 36π cm^3, so 1,728π ÷ 36π = 48 spheres.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 700

SI = 2,000 × 7 × 5/100 = ₹700.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 7040 m^2 and 11,968 m^2

CSA = 2πrh = 2 × 22/7 × 28 × 40 = 7,040 m^2. TSA = 2πr(r + h) = 2 × 22/7 × 28 × 68 = 11,968 m^2.

Q.16 · Answer (A) ₹12,000

The interest for 3.5 years at 12.5% is 43.75% of the principal, so the principal exceeds it by 56.25%: 0.5625P = 6,750 and P = ₹12,000.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 9

Walking in opposite directions they gain a full lap on each other 2 + 3 = 5 times a minute, so they meet every 1/5 minute: 10 times in 2 minutes. The 10th meeting falls at the end time itself (both are back at the start), so 9 fall between start and end.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (D) HO 7

The first letter moves 4 places back, the second 4 places forward and the number rises by 4: O → K, D → H, 11 → 15 and I → E, D → H, 5 → 9. So L → H, K → O and 3 → 7: HO 7.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Only conclusion (I) follows.

'Some gums are candies' converts to 'some candies are gums' (I). The gums that are candies are not balls, but nothing is said of the other gums, so II need not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 2
Facing the centre, a person's left is clockwise. Clockwise from A the seats are A, F, D, B, E, C, G: B is third to A's left, F and G flank A, C is immediately left of E and G is third to D's right. Counting to the left of F, D and B come before E: 2 people.

Q.6 · Answer (A) SKQM
Each letter moves 3 places back: O → L, G → D, M → J, I → F and S → P, K → H, Q → N, M → J. So VNTP → SKQM.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 4
O, L and F are in both words, as are 2, 6 and 8 in both codes. The letter left in WOLF is W and the digit left in its code is 4, so W = 4.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 36 and 28
Interchanging 36 and 28: 92 + 28 − 36 + (42 ÷ 3) − (22 × 4) = 92 + 28 − 36 + 14 − 88 = 10.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Only conclusion I follows
All pens are razors and all razors are creams, so all pens are creams (I). 'All razors are creams' does not make every cream a razor, so II does not follow.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 52, 520
The second number is 10 times the first: 23 × 10 = 230 and 46 × 10 = 460. Likewise 52 × 10 = 520.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 24
The second number is 3 times the first plus 3: 4 × 3 + 3 = 15 and 15 × 3 + 3 = 48. Likewise 7 × 3 + 3 = 24.

Q.15 · Answer (A) PTO
Each letter moves 3 places forward: D, G, J, M, P; H, K, N, Q, T; C, F, I, L, O. The next cluster is PTO.

Q.17 · Answer (D) – and ×
Interchanging – and ×: 39 ÷ 3 × 11 + 45 − 17 = 13 × 11 + 45 − 17 = 143 + 28 = 171.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 7
B is the only letter in both words and 7 the only digit in both codes, so B = 7.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 2
E is the only letter in both words and 2 the only digit in both codes, so E = 2.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 72
Each term is 6 more than the one before: 66 + 6 = 72.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Protolith
A protolith is the original rock from which a metamorphic rock forms. Regolith is the loose material over bedrock, and laterite a deeply weathered soil.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 1.21 billion
Census 2011 counted about 121 crore people: 1.21 billion.

Q.3 · Answer (C) To obey parents and discharge our family responsibilities
Article 51A lists the Fundamental Duties; obeying parents is not one of them. The other three options are duties (a), (b) and (c).

Q.4 · Answer (D) High amount of fat, adequate protein and low carbohydrate
A ketogenic diet is high in fat, moderate in protein and very low in carbohydrate, so the body burns fat for energy.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Baiga
Arjun Singh Dhurve of Dindori, Madhya Pradesh, received the Padma Shri in 2022 for keeping alive the dance and songs of the Baiga tribe.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Montane Forests
NCERT names magnolia, laurel, cinchona and wattle among the trees of the temperate forests (sholas) of the southern hills, part of India's montane forests.

Q.7 · Answer (C) West Bengal
West Bengal launched its Duare Ration (ration at the doorstep) scheme in 2021; in September 2022 a Calcutta High Court division bench held it ultra vires the National Food Security Act, 2013.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Brussels
Nehru represented the Indian National Congress at the Congress of Oppressed Nationalities in Brussels in February 1927, which founded the League against Imperialism.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Diana Edulji
Diana Edulji, a former India captain, was inducted into the ICC Hall of Fame in 2023, the first Indian woman to be so honoured.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Nitish Kumar
Nitish Kumar was sworn in as Chief Minister of Bihar for a record ninth time on 28 January 2024, after rejoining the NDA. (The question's 'January 2023' is a year out; none of the others has held the post nine times.)

Q.11 · Answer (C) Lord Jagannath
Puri's Rath Yatra takes Lord Jagannath, with Balabhadra and Subhadra, by chariot to the Gundicha Temple.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar and Syama Sastri
Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar and Syama Sastri, contemporaries of the late 18th and early 19th centuries, are the Trinity of Carnatic music.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Chief Minister
A state's Planning Board is chaired by its Chief Minister, as the Planning Commission was by the Prime Minister.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Greek
Ashoka's inscriptions in Afghanistan, such as the bilingual rock inscription at Kandahar, are in Greek and Aramaic.

Q.15 · Answer (D) all of the given options
SSC's key gives all three: government accounts in India are kept on a cash basis, so the revenue account takes in every revenue receipt and expenditure of the year, including arrears that belong to earlier years and amounts paid in advance for later ones. (In accrual accounting, as in an income and expenditure account, only items of the current year belong, which would point to 'current financial year'.)

Q.16 · Answer (D) Fang
India's cropping seasons are kharif, rabi and zaid; 'Fang' is not one of them.

Q.17 · Answer (D) The Forgotten Forms of Hindustani Music
Rabindra Bharali, a musicologist, wrote 'The Forgotten Forms of Hindustani Music' (2008), on lesser-known forms such as chaturang and trivat. 'The Music Room' is Namita Devidayal's memoir.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 80
Maharashtra topped the 37th National Games in Goa (2023) with 80 gold medals, 228 in all.

Q.20 · Answer (A) The f-block
Atomic number 59 is praseodymium, a lanthanide; the lanthanides fill the 4f orbitals and belong to the f-block.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Gypsum Mortar
The floor of the Great Bath at Mohenjodaro was made watertight with bricks set on edge in a mortar of gypsum.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Alvar
Andal, the only woman among the twelve Alvars, was a Tamil Vaishnava poet-saint. The Nayanars were devotees of Shiva.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Lalit Kala Akademi Award
The Lalit Kala Akademi honours the visual arts. The Sangeet Natak Akademi Award and the Kalidas Samman both count dance among their fields, and the Padma Shri is given in every field.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Mizoram
In Census 2011 Mizoram's child sex ratio, about 970 girls per 1,000 boys aged 0-6, was the highest of these four: Chhattisgarh and Kerala were in the 960s and Rajasthan below 890.

Q.25 · Answer (C) The Factory Act
The Indian Factories Act of 1881, passed under Lord Ripon, was India's first factory law: it barred children under seven from factories and limited the hours of child workers.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) its medicinal properties
The possessive of 'it' is 'its', with no apostrophe ('it's' means 'it is'); a plant's healing qualities are its 'medicinal properties'.

Q.2 · Answer (C) I will love.
The simple future is 'will' + the base form: 'I will love.' 'I love' is the simple present and 'I had loved' the past perfect.

Q.3 · Answer (C) difficult
After 'it's really' the blank needs an adjective: 'really difficult'. 'Difficulty' is a noun, and 'most difficult' does not follow 'really'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) farther
'Than' needs the comparative, and for distance it is 'farther': 'went farther than the blue car'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Embarrassment
'Embarrassment' is spelt correctly; the others should be 'occasion', 'receive' and 'accommodate'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) whispering
'Yelling' is loud shouting; its opposite in the sentence is 'whispering'. 'Shouting' and 'exclaiming' are close in meaning to it.

Q.7 · Answer (A) To have a selfish reason that influences the actions
To have 'an axe to grind' is to have a private, selfish reason for what one does.

Q.8 · Answer (C) She has been speaking
'Many times' counts completed occasions, which takes the present perfect, not the continuous: 'She has spoken to him on the subject many times.'

Q.9 · Answer (C) how to play a piano
SSC's key gives this segment: playing a musical instrument takes 'the', 'how to play the piano'. ('Class 6th' mixes 'Class 6' and 'the 6th class', but is common in Indian English.)

Q.10 · Answer (D) Bizarre
The correct spelling is 'bizarre', meaning very strange.

Q.11 · Answer (D) game-changer
A 'game-changer' is something that changes a situation decisively. The others mean something very hard to find, avoiding the point, and a hopeless search.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Delegation
Delegation is the act of entrusting one's authority or duties to another.

Q.13 · Answer (C) possibility of him
After 'the' a noun is needed, followed by 'of': 'the possibility of him being voted as the class monitor'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Cuorse
The correct spelling is 'course'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) silly
Nothing is being compared, so the positive degree is needed, matching 'irrelevant': 'silly and irrelevant'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Cruel
'Merciful' means showing kindness and forgiveness; its opposite is 'cruel'.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Lonely
'Isolated' means remote and solitary: the 'lonely' mountains.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Truthful
'Evasive' means avoiding a direct or honest answer; its opposite is 'truthful'. 'Elusive' and 'obscure' are close to synonyms.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Industrious
'Diligent' means hard-working: 'industrious'. 'Lazy' is its opposite.

Q.21 · Answer (D) who
'Who' is the relative pronoun for a person, the subject of 'sold': 'a milkmaid who sold the milk'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) got
The milk that she 'got', that is obtained, from her own cows; she did not buy it.

Q.23 · Answer (D) would
'Would' expresses a past habit: 'She would carry the milk in a big mud pitcher.'

Q.24 · Answer (C) with
She was walking 'with' the big pitcher on her head.

Q.25 · Answer (B) earn
One 'earns' money by selling something: the money she would 'earn' from selling the milk.

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